

COW Notes
1.13.2021
5:30 via Zoom

ROLL: called by Secretary Melanie McLaughlin
Kathy Kreatz, Mea Mustone, Melanie McLaughlin, Paul Ruseau, Paulette Van der Kloot, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn

Joan Bowen Presenting Report on Shore Collaborative

Background information in packet on Shore Collaborative

- Medford is one of the founding districts in Shore Collaborative. Provides high quality cost effective services to their districts. Wide range of programs:
- Intensive multiple modalities program
- Intensive skill and language program for kids with autism
- Transitional Program for ages 18 - 22
- Therapeutic programs for all levels for students with anxiety and depression
- Offer a 45 day evaluation for violations of school discipline codes
- Offers extended evaluation 40 days looking at the questions that need to be answered about this student?

Other members: Cambridge, Chelsea, Everett, Malden, Winthrop , Revere, Saugus, Somerville

Kathy Medaglio now works for Shore.

Shore operations meetings: all Pupil services directors from member districts get together to problem solve and offer resources to one another. First Friday every month.

Enrollment: MPS has four students enrolled:
2 participate in extended school year programming
1 is having a 45 day evaluation

Melanie McLaughlin: wondering if we can get reports from the other collaboratives as well.

Joan Bowen: We are not member districts with the other collaboratives. We have had higher numbers in the past but we have been looking at building better programs in the district.

Melanie McLaughlin: questions about students violating school discipline codes. Discipline Problems don't sound the best. Would these behavioral situations be a manifestation of the disability.

Joan Bowen: Sometimes an interim situation as they go through the court system. Usually felonies such as drug and weapons violations.

Melanie McLaughlin: if we have students without disabilities, is this where we have the interim placements?

Mayor: could you go through the autism evaluation process?

Joan Bowen: Every student goes through an initial evaluation. Do they require specialized services?

We look at their individual needs and not rush to a particular program. We try the least restrictive environment. If the program is not working, we reconvene the team, look at other assessments, review the information. May consider the Roberts Connections Program. If we have exhausted all of our resources in Medford, we meet with the parents to address the IEP and consider out of district placements. Approximately 37 out of district placements.

Melanie McLaughlin: the parent can reject the IEP and request out of district placement. If a student has a disciplinary infraction, they can be referred for the 45 evaluation period however there is also a manifestation of disability to determine if the infraction is due to a disability. IE. Would disrobing be a manifestation of a student with autism's disability.

Joan Bowen: Extended evaluation is not a placement. After that time period, they may not stay at shore or the other outplacement location. After 10 suspensions, the team meets for a manifestation of disability. If it is, the student cannot be suspended for that infraction in the future. If it is not, then it follows the standard code of discipline. A functional behavioral assessment will be conducted. It is a long legal process.

Jenny Graham: We need to talk about the revolving accounts labeled Shore Collaborative: We have a Shore tuition account and I am looking at the KP report from March 26, it listed only revenue in that account?

Joan Bowen: I am unsure of the report you are referring to but I am happy to connect with you on this?

Jenny Graham: How is the revolving account typically used?

Joan Bowen: We keep track of the tuition payments that we need to pay on a monthly basis and get that report to finance.

Jenny Graham: report doesn't add up. It mentions debits and credits.

Joan Bowen: We may get a credit if we don't use all of our slots.

Paulette Van der Kloot: We get revenue from Shore for use of classrooms in our buildings.

Joan Bowen: they used to use a room in the Columbus School but are no longer due to low enrollment.

Melanie McLaughlin: I would also like to ask what supports are being provided to those students who are out of district.

Jenny Graham: This is the only document in the share drive. I would like to have an understanding of the ins and outs of the revolving accounts.

Paul Ruseau: Does medicaid money come into the schools or the city for Shore?

Katie Ciampoli: Report on MEEP
Sharing presentation

MEEP: Medford Early Education Program

Originally designed for students aged 3 to 5 with disabilities

We have 7 teachers right now

All are integrated programs (kids with and without disabilities)

All attend 4 days a week (cohort A)

Brooks: 2 half day programs

Columbus: extended AM 9 to 1; 1 - 2 just students with disabilities to get one on one services

McGlynn: 9 to 2:05

Roberts: Extended AM and a Late am

Mission:

Inclusive preschool program: independence, self confidence, enthusiasm for learning

- Lively Letters: Multi sensory way of learning letters and sounds: Early literacy program
- Zones of regulation (also used in elementary)
- Music Therapy (grant written by a parent for a music therapist to come in)
- Mass Curriculum Frameworks does provide Pre-K guidelines
- Progress reports are given twice per year
- Tuition rates on spreadsheet. Sliding scale is available for families needing assistance.

Paul Ruseau: Music Therapy grant - was it one year?

Katie Ciampoli: 12 weeks

Paul Ruseau: did it go well?

Katie Ciampoli: Teachers loved it. I observed the classes. Students were very engaged. We hoped to include it in the budget but it wasn't feasible. We will try again next year.

Paul Ruseau: Could we increase the costs of the program to be able to include it?

Melanie McLaughlin : Reminds me of something Jenny Graham. Meep is a shining star in our district. Model of inclusion. Full day program ten years ago was a great innovative addition. I encourage you to request the music therapy program. The data for inclusion shows benefits to both students with and without disabilities in models of inclusion.

What is the difference between MEEP and the McGlynn preschool?

Katie Ciampoli: we don't have the McGlynn preschool any more. It was grant funded. It was a classroom of 20 students (5 of whom could be with disabilities). Meep classrooms have a max of 15 (7 with and 8 without disabilities).

Melanie McLaughlin: Grant covered the three students. Tuition came in from the 17 students.

Katie Ciampoli: the state didn't fund the grant last year.

Melanie McLaughlin: Is that why it doesn't exist this year? How was that made?

Joan Bowen: grant ended and we made a decision as a school district during COVID to end it. We are looking to DESE to see if that grant will come back.

Melanie McLaughlin: But we also lost 17 seats of income. Affects revolving account.

Mayor Lungo-KoeHN: At some point can we take a look at the revolving accounts before the first budget meetings?

Jenny Graham: Katie thanks for the spreadsheet. It would be helpful to have a real budgetary discussion about MEEP. I believe we need to vote on rates per our lawyer. It strikes me that Medford's programming is far below market rate. We need to think about it carefully because we are not flush with cash. I don't have a sense of what our enrollment vs. our capacity. I have heard that the hours are not aligned with the school day so drop off and pick ups can be inconvenient. I believe there is a desire for universal pre-k so how do we start to think strategically about how we can look at our sliding scale offerings? Do you get more applications than spots? Is it an issue of space?

Joan Bowen: Teacher salaries are in the SPED budget. Tuition that comes in doesn't cover the staffing. We may need to look at this with Dave on this.

Katie Ciampoli: I haven't requested any of the money in my time.

Jenny Graham: In order to expand programs, we need to look at the costs/revenue of MEEP. Back to the topic of the revolving accounts, we need to look at it. I heard music therapy was a great program. Perhaps tuition could cover that.

Katie Ciampoli: Numbers are very different this year because we are operating at half capacity.
Less tuition coming in.

Motion to adjourn: Melanie McLaughlin, Paulette Van der Kloot seconded.
Roll call: 7 in favor. Meeting adjourned at 6:35 pm